

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Human Values and Lessons from Leaders - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Human Values and Lessons from Leaders

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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|--|--|
| 1 Where values come from and how they become character | 2 Turning values into public-service choices |
| 3 Gandhi: keeping means and ends ethically connected | 4 Learning courage and calm from Indian exemplars |
| 5 Mahavir: many-sided truth and non-possession | 6 Kautilya and the design of corruption controls |
| 7 Duty without craving credit: Nishkama karma | 8 Reform through education: Savitribai Phule and Kalam |
| 9 How to use a leader without hero-worship | 10 Writing quotation answers that earn GS-IV marks |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Human Values and Lessons from Leaders - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g1 **PYQ ownership:** Questions labelled as official reproduce the locally held UPSC GS-IV papers; routed historical demands are explicitly neutral renderings rather than invented quotations.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A district training academy combines classroom ethics with supervisors who disclose conflicts and correct false field reports even when no audit is expected. Which explanation best captures why this can build integrity? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Value formation is social and revisable** is the controlling principle. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A recruit says that values learnt at home make later training irrelevant. Her mentor instead uses reflection, peer feedback and transparent work routines. Which view correctly distinguishes early conditioning from later internalisation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: B

Explanation: Value formation is social and revisable is the controlling principle. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

An officer refuses a contractor's hospitality only during vigilance inspections but accepts it in private after the inspection team leaves. Is this best described as internalised probity or externally managed performance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- B. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- C. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- D. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.

Answer: C

Explanation: Internalisation differs from performance is the controlling principle. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

A block officer corrects an overpayment before releasing funds although the error is unlikely to be detected and the correction delays the target. What feature most strongly indicates internalisation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: D

Explanation: Internalisation differs from performance is the controlling principle. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A trainee warmly supports a cleanliness campaign but falsifies attendance in an unrelated training programme. Which distinction explains why a positive campaign attitude alone does not establish honesty as a value? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: A

Explanation: Values are broader than attitudes is the controlling principle. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

A school evaluates students only by whether they can repeat slogans on integrity. What addition would better assess value education rather than temporary attitude display? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- B. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- C. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- D. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.

Answer: B

Explanation: Values are broader than attitudes is the controlling principle. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

A department records every official's course completion on iGOT and declares corruption impossible. Which qualification follows from the distinction between competency exposure and ethical conduct under temptation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: C

Explanation: Mission Karmayogi is an institutional channel is the controlling principle. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

A service redesign maps roles at a citizen-facing office, identifies empathy and problem-solving gaps, and assigns relevant learning modules. Which Mission Karmayogi logic is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.

Answer: D

Explanation: Mission Karmayogi is an institutional channel is the controlling principle. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

A municipality meets its revenue target by pressuring small vendors to pay unofficial fees while publicising new parks. Which Gandhi-style diagnosis is most precise: failure of outcomes, or wealth and politics detached from ethical means? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- C. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Gandhi's social sins join means to ends is the controlling principle. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

A research unit obtains useful health data by concealing consent conditions from participants. Which social-sin pairing most directly identifies the ethical failure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.

Answer: B

Explanation: Gandhi's social sins join means to ends is the controlling principle. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

A candidate writes that Gandhi personally coined every word of a fixed seven-item list and quotes 'leisure' as the original wording. What correction preserves both exam utility and provenance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: C

Explanation: Gandhi list provenance needs care is the controlling principle. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

A civil-service ethics poster uses the ARC wording but footnotes it as a list Gandhi published and endorsed, noting the pleasure/leisure variation. Why is this preferable to treating a popular slogan as a settled primary text? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- C. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- D. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Gandhi list provenance needs care is the controlling principle. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

A State copies a foreign digital grievance platform despite weak connectivity and language access in tribal blocks. A district team proposes local-language assisted kiosks while retaining transparent tracking. Which response best follows the teaching? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- C. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Vivekananda supports adaptation, not imitation is the controlling principle. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

An official rejects every practice from another country because it is foreign. Why is this no more faithful to Vivekananda's proposition than mechanical transplantation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.

Answer: B

Explanation: Vivekananda supports adaptation, not imitation is the controlling principle. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

A flood-control officer sincerely believes in protecting vulnerable residents but neither prepares evacuation plans nor acts against an influential encroacher. What does the faith-and-strength proposition reveal about this failure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.

Answer: C

Explanation: Faith requires capacity and resolve is the controlling principle. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A candidate assigns the exact quotation to a named Patel speech without evidence. What is the responsible way to retain the governance lesson while handling the attribution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: D

Explanation: Faith requires capacity and resolve is the controlling principle. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

During a landslide, a Sub-Divisional Magistrate remains calm, verifies road access, communicates uncertainty honestly and orders evacuation. Which element shows equanimity rather than emotional detachment? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- B. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Thiruvalluvar teaches active equanimity** is the controlling principle. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

A supervisor tells an officer facing a communal rumour to wait silently because 'trouble troubles itself.' Which reading of the quotation is conceptually wrong? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- D. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Thiruvalluvar teaches active equanimity** is the controlling principle. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

A probationer reframes a difficult rural posting as a chance to learn local administration, seeks feedback and improves service access. What valid insight about attitude change can be drawn without claiming the disputed wording is a James primary text? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.

Answer: C

Explanation: **William James provenance and usable idea** is the controlling principle. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

A coaching note cites the exact 2025 wording as a proved James discovery. What provenance correction should an examiner reward? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- B. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.

Answer: D

Explanation: **William James provenance and usable idea** is the controlling principle. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

A district reduces road deaths through fair enforcement, road engineering and local campaigns against drunk driving. Why would relying only on penalties or only on moral appeals both be incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- C. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Law needs social morality but not replacement** is the controlling principle. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

An officer excuses a procurement violation because her intention was good and morality matters more than rules. Which limit on the proposition defeats that reasoning? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Law needs social morality but not replacement** is the controlling principle. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

Before a land-acquisition decision, an officer hears cultivators, women workers, engineers and environmental experts, records reasons and chooses a lawful option. Which Jain-informed administrative discipline is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.

Answer: C

Explanation: Anekantavada is not moral relativism is the controlling principle. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A chairperson refuses to decide a safety dispute because all viewpoints are equally true. Why is this an incorrect use of Anekantavada? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: D

Explanation: Anekantavada is not moral relativism is the controlling principle. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A licensing officer removes herself from a file involving her sibling's firm and records the conflict. Which public-service expression of Aparigraha is most direct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- C. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: A

Explanation: Aparigraha translates into probity is the controlling principle. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

A hospital superintendent refuses to purchase essential equipment, claiming that avoiding all possession is ethically superior. What error confuses non-possessiveness with neglect of public duty? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- B. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Aparigraha translates into probity is the controlling principle. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

A district finds that storekeepers can alter stock registers without independent reconciliation. It introduces separation of duties, random checks and transparent records. Which Kautilyan insight is being operationalised? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.

Answer: C

Explanation: Kautilya identifies opportunity and concealment is the controlling principle. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A minister argues that only morally weak people need controls, so trusted officers should never be audited. Which part of Kautilya's reasoning challenges this view? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: D

Explanation: Kautilya identifies opportunity and concealment is the controlling principle. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

A department rotates all officers suddenly after an anonymous complaint, without recorded criteria or review. Why is this weaker than a transparent, risk-based rotation and integrity-support system? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Kautilya is not surveillance alone** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

A procurement unit rewards accurate disclosure, protects reporters and conducts proportionate audits. Which balance distinguishes institutional vigilance from demoralising suspicion? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- B. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- C. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Kautilya is not surveillance alone** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

An officer completes a difficult vaccination drive, credits frontline workers and accepts that promotion may not follow, while tracking missed settlements. Why is this duty without attachment rather than indifference to results? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.

Answer: C

Explanation: Nishkama karma rejects personal attachment is the controlling principle. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

A colleague ignores repeated pension delays saying that one should not care about outcomes. Which conceptual distinction exposes the misuse of Nishkama karma? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- D. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.

Answer: D

Explanation: Nishkama karma rejects personal attachment is the controlling principle. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

A revenue officer stays late to resolve pension grievances but documents workload risks, delegates lawfully and asks for staff support. How does this better express devotion to duty than heroic but unsustainable overwork? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- C. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- D. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.

Answer: A

Explanation: Duty joins responsibility and fulfilment is the controlling principle. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

A superior orders an officer to suppress an inconvenient inspection report and calls obedience 'duty.' What boundary must a Nishkama karma answer state? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- B. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Duty joins responsibility and fulfilment is the controlling principle. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

A district responds to girls' dropout by opening safe transport, recruiting local women educators and supporting adolescent re-entry rather than merely holding a ceremonial speech. Which Savitribai-inspired lesson is most accurately applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- D. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.

Answer: C

Explanation: Savitribai Phule models institution-building is the controlling principle. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

A programme celebrates women achievers annually but leaves school toilets, safety and caste-linked exclusion unaddressed. What structural limitation does the Phule example reveal? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- C. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: D

Explanation: Savitribai Phule models institution-building is the controlling principle. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A school programme combines integrity practice, respectful family dialogue and civic projects, while the district also improves complaint systems. Why is this stronger than claiming personal virtue alone automatically creates national order? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.

Answer: A

Explanation: Kalam's chain is attributed with care is the controlling principle. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

An answer calls the righteousness-to-peace chain Kalam's original theorem and treats it as statistical proof. Which two cautions are missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Kalam's chain is attributed with care is the controlling principle. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

In a mining dispute, an officer invokes Gandhi's conscience but does not consult affected communities, apply law or assess environmental evidence. What makes the invocation ethically incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- D. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.

Answer: C

Explanation: Exemplars need contextual translation is the controlling principle. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

A candidate uses Mahavir to justify consultation, then explains the statutory decision, recorded reasons and review process. Why is this better than biography-led answer writing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.

Answer: D

Explanation: Exemplars need contextual translation is the controlling principle. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

For a quotation on courage, a candidate spends 120 of 150 words listing the leader's life events and gives no governance application. What central demand of the question remains unmet? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- B. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- C. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Quotation answers test translation is the controlling principle. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

Another candidate links courage to documented whistleblower protection, gives a district-level example and warns against reckless disclosure of personal data. Which answer architecture is demonstrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.

Answer: B

Explanation: Quotation answers test translation is the controlling principle. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

A department responds to procurement risk by conducting ethics discussions but retains opaque single-person approvals. What missing half of the values-plus-institutions approach remains? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- B. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- C. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- D. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.

Answer: C

Explanation: Values and institutions must work together is the controlling principle. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

Another department digitises every approval but rewards target completion even when field staff mislead citizens. Which ethical capability is still vulnerable despite stronger controls? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: D

Explanation: Values and institutions must work together is the controlling principle. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

A matching question says Mahavir introduced ethical self-restraint for the first time by inventing Brahmacharya. Which precise correction follows from the tradition described in the owner? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- C. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Brahmacharya requires textual precision is the controlling principle. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

An administrator describes the five vows as a complete manual for replacing constitutional law. Which distinction between ethical teaching and public institutional duty is being ignored? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: B

Explanation: Brahmacharya requires textual precision is the controlling principle. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

A presentation claims that 7.26 crore completions establish that every official has become impartial. Which inference exceeds what the reported data can show? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: C

Explanation: Competency scale is not conduct proof is the controlling principle. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

A training director uses the figures to argue for multilingual access and then proposes observed behavioural practice and citizen feedback. Why is this a more defensible use of the data? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.

Answer: D

Explanation: Competency scale is not conduct proof is the controlling principle. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (a) "Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it, do not become others." -Swami Vivekananda (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(a), verbatim English wording. The line is traceable to Complete Works, Vol. III, The Common Bases of Hinduism (Lahore, 1897).

Model solution

The quotation advocates discerning learning rather than imitation. It asks a society or civil servant to absorb useful knowledge through its own needs, constitutional values and social conditions. In administration, it means that reform should retain a tested principle while adapting its delivery, language and safeguards to Indian realities.

For example, a State may learn from a foreign digital grievance-redress model, but should provide assisted counters, local-language access, offline receipt options and an appeal route where connectivity or literacy is weak. The value is neither cultural isolation nor cosmetic localisation; it is informed adaptation that improves equal access and accountability.

The principle also disciplines public-service learning. An officer should study successful procurement, health or urban-service practices elsewhere, test their assumptions, consult affected groups and document why an adaptation fits the local context. Blind transplantation can exclude citizens; reflexive rejection can preserve avoidable inefficiency.

Thus, the present relevance of Vivekananda's thought is ethical self-respect joined to openness. Borrow what advances public welfare, but translate it through constitutional equality, citizen experience and verifiable results. That makes learning a responsible public act rather than imitation for prestige.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (b) "Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength. Faith and strength, both are essential to accomplish any great work-" -Sardar Patel (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(b), verbatim English wording. UPSC attribution retained; no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced in the Basic owner.

Model solution

The proposition conveys that moral conviction becomes socially useful only when joined to strength: competence, courage, organisation and perseverance. Faith supplies direction and legitimacy; strength turns that direction into effective action. A civil servant therefore needs both an ethical commitment to public welfare and the capacity to implement it fairly.

Consider disaster management. Sympathy for flood-affected families is inadequate without credible warnings, trained teams, accessible shelters, transparent relief lists and courage to act against unsafe encroachment. Conversely, administrative power without ethical purpose can become coercive or serve the influential. The public value lies in their combination.

In daily governance, this means preparing files carefully, mastering rules, communicating honestly and resisting improper pressure. A district officer who believes in girls' education must also build safe transport, coordinate schools and address exclusion. Good intentions without execution disappoint citizens; technical efficiency without conscience may deepen inequity.

There is an attribution caution: the quotation is set by UPSC as Sardar Patel's, but the Basic owner does not trace it to a primary speech or letter. That does not weaken its ethical idea. The sound verdict is that public service needs values to choose the right end and institutional capability to reach it lawfully.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (c) "In law, a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics, he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so." -Immanuel Kant (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(c), verbatim English wording. This topic routes the demand as a legality-versus-ethics application.

Model solution

The quotation distinguishes external legality from the moral quality of intention. Law normally punishes an established violation of another's rights; ethics asks an earlier question: whether one is willing to treat another person merely as a means. In public office, this distinction encourages conscience before misconduct becomes an actionable wrong.

An officer may have discretion to accept lavish hospitality that escapes a narrowly framed rule. Even before any quid pro quo occurs, accepting it can impair impartiality and public trust. Similarly, a supervisor who plans to suppress an inconvenient inspection may not yet have falsified a record, but the intention already reveals disregard for citizens' entitlement to truthful administration.

This does not mean that the State should punish private thoughts. Due process, evidence and legality remain essential; administrative action cannot be based on speculative moral policing. The practical translation is preventive ethics: disclose conflicts, recuse where necessary, maintain reasoned records and use codes and training to interrupt harmful intent before it becomes conduct.

Thus, the quotation expands responsibility beyond fear of punishment. A civil servant should ask not only, 'Can I do this legally?' but also, 'Can I justify it as respectful, impartial and fair to those affected?' That inner test strengthens, rather than replaces, lawful accountability.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3-(a) "Those who in trouble untroubled are, Will trouble trouble itself." - Thiruvalluvar (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(a), verbatim English wording. The Basic owner treats it as a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623, not a named historic translation.

Model solution

The quotation conveys equanimity under adversity. A calm mind does not deny danger; it prevents fear, anger and confusion from multiplying the original problem. For a civil servant, composure is therefore an operational virtue because it permits accurate assessment, humane communication and timely action in a crisis.

During a landslide or communal rumour, an officer should verify facts, activate response teams, communicate what is known and unknown, protect vulnerable groups and record decisions. Panic can spread misinformation and favour arbitrary action; disciplined calm helps the administration coordinate police, health workers and local representatives. The lesson is visible in a district control room that prioritises verified warnings and evacuation over dramatic but unsupported announcements.

Equanimity has a boundary. It is not passivity, emotional coldness or delay disguised as patience. A collector who remains serene while failing to order rescue, hear grievances or correct an error has misunderstood the teaching. Compassionate urgency must accompany inner steadiness.

The wording should also be handled carefully: it is a modern paraphrase linked by the Basic owner to Tirukkural 623, whose theme is not being distressed by adversity. The reasoned verdict is that calm leadership makes trouble manageable when it is joined to evidence, decisive lawful action and empathy.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3-(b) "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(b), verbatim English wording. Widely attributed to William James but not traceable to his writings; popularised by Norman Vincent Peale (1952).

Model solution

The idea conveys that attitudes are not wholly fixed: conscious reflection, learning and repeated practice can change how a person interprets difficulty and therefore how that person acts. In public service, this matters because an officer's attitude toward citizens, marginalised groups and unfamiliar postings shapes the quality of discretionary service.

A probationer initially treating a remote posting as punishment may, through field immersion and feedback, recognise local knowledge, learn the language and redesign access to welfare services. The changed attitude does not alter material constraints by wish alone; it changes attention, effort and willingness to collaborate. Training, mentoring and transparent work routines can therefore support behavioural competence alongside technical skill.

The proposition must not become victim-blaming. Poverty, discrimination, administrative opacity and inadequate staffing cannot be solved by asking citizens or employees merely to think positively. Structural reform, lawful entitlements and institutional accountability remain indispensable.

There is also a provenance caution. The exact sentence is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings in the Basic owner; it was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale. The answer should analyse the proposition, not invent a James citation. The verdict is that reflective attitude change is a real ethical resource when paired with fair institutions and concrete action.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3- (c) "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." - Swami Vivekananda (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(c), verbatim English wording. UPSC attribution retained; the wording is not traceable to Vivekananda's Complete Works in the Basic owner.

Model solution

The proposition highlights that law works best when citizens and officials possess internalised morality. No police force or rule book can observe every transaction, road crossing or exercise of discretion. Honesty, empathy and civic responsibility therefore reduce the gap between formal compliance and lived public order.

For instance, road safety improves not only through penalties but when drivers refuse drunk driving, communities discourage unsafe conduct and enforcement remains impartial. Likewise, welfare delivery depends on officials who do not demand informal payments and citizens who do not fabricate claims. Such everyday morality preserves trust and lowers the cost of enforcement.

However, morality cannot replace law. Social majorities can hold prejudices, and good intentions may be disputed. Constitutional rights, due process, transparent procedures and independent review protect persons precisely when informal morality fails. A procurement officer cannot ignore conflict-of-interest rules by asserting a moral purpose.

The exact line should be treated as a 2025 UPSC attribution, not as a verified primary Vivekananda quotation; the nearest documented theme in the owner is his concern that many laws may be little regarded. The balanced verdict is that ethical citizenship gives law its social strength, while just institutions channel morality, protect minorities and hold power accountable.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: What are the major teachings of Mahavir? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q4(b), verbatim English wording.

Model solution

Mahavir's major teachings include the five Mahavratas: Ahimsa (non-violence), Satya (truthfulness), Asteya (non-stealing), Brahmacharya (self-restraint) and Aparigraha (non-possessiveness). Jain thought also develops Anekantavada, the many-sidedness of truth, and Syadvada, conditional predication. Together they cultivate restraint, truth, non-harm and humility in judgement.

Their contemporary relevance is practical. Ahimsa supports non-violent conflict resolution and humane treatment of vulnerable persons. Satya and Asteya strengthen honest records and resistance to misuse of public resources. Aparigraha provides an ethical basis for conflict-of-interest disclosure, anti-nepotism and non-attachment to office-derived gain. Before land acquisition or environmental clearance, Anekantavada supports serious consultation with cultivators, workers, experts and affected communities; it improves knowledge and legitimacy.

Yet many-sidedness is not moral relativism. A public authority must eventually decide on lawful evidence and record reasons; it cannot say that every claim is equally valid. Nor can personal restraint substitute for rights, rules and enforcement. Brahmacharya should be described carefully as separately enumerated in Mahavir's tradition, not casually as an idea he demonstrably invented.

Therefore, Mahavir's teaching remains relevant as an ethical discipline for plural societies: listen widely, harm less, speak truthfully and restrain private gain, while acting through constitutional institutions.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q5(a), verbatim English wording.

Model solution

The statement reflects Nishkama karma: duty is performed with full commitment but without attachment to personal reward, credit or promotion. For a civil servant, responsibility means timely, competent and fair action because citizens depend on the office, not because recognition is assured. Personal fulfilment follows from meaningful service and integrity, rather than from status alone.

In a pension camp, devotion to duty would mean identifying delayed cases, correcting records, communicating reasons and ensuring that elderly claimants are not forced through avoidable visits. The officer may share credit with frontline staff and still measure whether the service actually reached people. This is not indifference to results; it is non-attachment to private gain combined with rigorous concern for public outcomes.

Duty has ethical limits. It does not require obeying an unlawful order, accepting chronic overwork as virtue or disregarding affected citizens in the name of efficiency. A responsible officer records dissent where necessary, seeks lawful support and protects both service quality and staff welfare.

Mission Karmayogi's focus on functional and behavioural competencies offers an institutional setting in which such responsibility can be practised, but course completion alone cannot demonstrate character. The verdict is that devoted duty unites inner fulfilment with accountable public action when it is guided by legality, empathy and measurable citizen welfare.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how family, educational institutions and public-service training can move a value from social instruction to internalised administrative conduct. Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

A value becomes internalised when it guides conduct even without surveillance. Family supplies early modelling: honesty in small transactions and respect for others make moral language concrete. Schools deepen it through discussion, fair rules, service learning and teachers whose conduct matches instruction. Public-service training must then test the value under real discretion.

For example, a trainee may learn compassion through community immersion, practise it by redesigning a disability-access counter, and receive feedback from citizens rather than merely memorising a definition. Mission Karmayogi can support such development through functional and behavioural competencies, role-based learning and iGOT access.

However, lectures and course completions do not prove integrity. Opaque targets, political pressure and reward for only numerical output can corrode a value. Training should be reinforced by transparent procedures, mentoring, reasoned records and safe reporting channels.

Thus, inculcation is a continuing social and institutional process: example begins it, practice tests it, and accountable work culture makes it durable.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Gandhi's Seven Social Sins are more useful as a diagnostic of ethical means than as a complete governance programme. Discuss. Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Gandhi's published-and-endorsed list identifies moral decoupling: politics from principle, wealth from work, commerce from morality, knowledge from character and similar separations. It is a sharp diagnostic because it asks whether an attractive outcome has been pursued through exploitative, deceptive or dehumanising means.

A procurement office may deliver a project on time yet tolerate collusive bidding. The list exposes why target achievement cannot cleanse an unfair process. Likewise, science without humanity cautions a health-data project that obtains useful information without meaningful consent.

Its limitation is institutional. A moral warning does not specify audit design, appeal procedures, sanctions or protection for an honest official. The ARC's textual context also warrants care: the 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent, and 'pleasure' appears where ARC prints 'leisure.'

Therefore, the list should guide ethical scrutiny, while codes, transparency, conflict-of-interest rules and citizen oversight supply enforceable governance. Character identifies the wrong; institutions help prevent and correct it.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Gandhi's character-centred warning with Kautilya's opportunity-centred account of corruption. What balanced vigilance design follows for a district administration? Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Gandhi and Kautilya illuminate different but complementary causes of corruption. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins warn that wealth, politics and commerce become corrupt when detached from conscience, work, principle and morality. His lens asks whether the actor has internalised ethical restraint. Kautilya's honey and fish analogies, quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2), begin from a harder administrative fact: officials handling public money face temptation and concealment, so character cannot be the sole safeguard.

A balanced district design should therefore combine moral formation with opportunity reduction. Induction and mentoring can discuss integrity, citizen dignity and conflicts of interest. Simultaneously, the administration should separate sanction, payment and verification roles; reconcile stock and beneficiary records; publish criteria; conduct proportionate risk-based audits; and preserve appeal and whistleblower channels. Honest performance should receive recognition and lawful continuity, reflecting Kautilya's positive element, while wrongful accumulation should be investigated through due process.

Neither pole is sufficient. Gandhi alone can become a sermon that ignores opaque incentives. Kautilya alone can become indiscriminate suspicion, punitive transfers and demoralisation of honest staff. Rotation without objective criteria is not vigilance.

The reasoned conclusion is values plus institutions: cultivate conscience for unobserved choices, but design transparent systems because even good people should not be asked to resist avoidable temptation alone.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: How can Anekantavada and Aparigraha improve a civil servant's handling of a contested development project without producing indecision or anti-development romanticism? Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Anekantavada teaches that a complex truth-claim has multiple standpoints; Aparigraha teaches non-possessiveness and restraint toward private gain. Together they can improve development administration by making consultation substantive and decision-making less vulnerable to capture.

In a contested renewable-energy or road project, Anekantavada requires the officer to hear landholders, women workers, Scheduled Tribe representatives, engineers, environmental experts and local bodies. The officer should disclose the evidence, distinguish facts from fears, consider alternatives and record reasons for the selected option. This is not a veto for every interest; it is epistemic humility before a lawful, timely decision.

Aparigraha adds a probity discipline. The officer must disclose relationships with bidders, recuse from conflicted files, reject gifts and ensure that compensation or rehabilitation decisions are not distorted by family, political or commercial gain. It directs attention from possession to trusteeship of public power.

The limits matter. Many-sidedness is not relativism: safety norms, rights and statutory mandates set non-negotiable boundaries. Non-possession is not refusal to build infrastructure or spend public funds; neglecting a needed project can also harm citizens.

Hence, Jain ethics supports development that is evidence-led, participatory and conflict-of-interest-free. Its mature administrative translation is a reasoned decision with safeguards, not endless consultation or moral display.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Leader-based ethics can humanise public administration, but it can also obscure institutional responsibility. Critically examine with reference to Gandhi, Vivekananda, Savitribai Phule and A.P.J. Abdul Kalam. Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Leader-based ethics humanises administration by converting abstract values into memorable moral tests. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins warn an officer against commerce without morality or politics without principle; they make means as important as targets. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 teaching on learning from others without becoming them supports contextual adaptation rather than borrowed prestige. Savitribai Phule's 1848 Bhide Wada girls' school demonstrates that equality requires institution-building, not sympathetic rhetoric. Kalam's popularly used righteousness-to-peace chain encourages an officer to see personal integrity as socially consequential.

These lessons can improve public service. A district adapting an e-governance platform should retain transparency but add local-language and assisted access. A girls' education plan should move beyond celebration to safe transport, teachers and re-entry support. An officer confronted by a gift from a bidder can use Gandhi's means-ends test before any formal violation occurs.

However, exemplary names are not a substitute for constitutional design. Gandhi's list does not specify audit trails or appeal systems. Kalam's chain is an aspiration, not proof that private virtue alone causes national order; moreover, he credited it to Sathya Sai Baba in a 2007 European Parliament address. The 2025 Vivekananda law-and-morality wording is not traceable to the Complete Works, so an answer must analyse the idea rather than invent provenance. Hero worship can silence affected voices, reduce a dilemma to biography, or excuse officials who profess noble motives while breaching procedure.

The proper method is translation: state the teaching, identify a decision rule, use an Indian illustration, and add institutional safeguards. The verdict is qualified: exemplars make ethical imagination vivid, but accountable governance needs transparent rules, evidence, participation and remedies alongside character.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate Mission Karmayogi as an institutional bridge between human values and citizen-centred public service. What can it enable, and what must not be claimed from it? Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Mission Karmayogi, under the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building, is relevant to human values because it shifts capacity-building attention from a narrow rules orientation toward roles, competencies and the citizen-government interface. DoPT's NPCSCB framework includes functional and behavioural competencies, while iGOT provides a learning platform. This creates an institutional route through which empathy, integrity, problem-solving and duty can be practised alongside technical capability.

Its promise is visible at the service-delivery level. A role-based module can help a citizen-facing official recognise accessibility barriers, communicate reasons for a decision, manage conflict and use a grievance system responsibly. Learning may be connected to mentoring, field reflection and redesign of a pension, health or land-service workflow. The Basic owner reports figures dated 6 February 2026: 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages. These facts demonstrate reach and multilingual availability.

But reach is not internalisation. A completed course does not prove that an officer will resist a conflicted contractor, treat a claimant with dignity or report an improper order. Behaviour can be performed for a dashboard. Nor should an answer invent a general APAR linkage: the owner expressly says not to claim one without a service-specific DoPT order.

Mission Karmayogi should therefore be supplemented by fair workload design, transparent discretion, citizen feedback, ethical leadership, conflict-of-interest safeguards and due-process accountability. Its achievement is to make values learnable and role-relevant; its limit is that character and culture are tested in real choices. The reasoned verdict is that it is a valuable bridge, not a certificate of ethical governance in every service setting.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.